relation to the President), they simultaneously laid flowers at the memorial to members of the Slovenian anti-fascist resistance executed in 1930 (formally still characterised by the Italian legal system as terrorists) and at the memorial to Italians (and other anti-Communists) massacred by Yugoslav partisans in the immediate aftermath of World War II, then thrown into natural caves, called *foibe* in Italian. Their gesture became an object of heavy criticism by both the radical left in Slovenia and some of Giorgia Meloni's loyalists in Italy. But in the big picture, it became evident that while the dismantling of Central Europe took two wars to be completed, it took even longer to make some (if not full) sense of the events that are the subject of the next chapter.

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29. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Molvan%C3%AEa
30. http://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/europe/3592753.stm
31. Fichtner, p. 145.
32. Published by Alfred A. Knopf, New York, 1917.
33. In Trieste/Trst region, the ambitions for Italian national unity found the local ethnic Slovenians on the Austrian side of the fence subjected to growing pressure, discrimination and, with the advent of Fascism, outright persecution.
34. 'The Nazis treated Western Europeans with some respect, if only the better to exploit them, and Western Europeans returned the compliment by doing relatively little to disrupt or oppose the German war effort. In Eastern and South-eastern Europe the occupying Germans were merciless, and not only because local partisans – in Greece, Yugoslavia and Ukraine especially – fought a relentless if hopeless battle against them.' See Tony Judt, *Postwar: A History of Europe since 1945*, William Heinemann, London, 2005, p. 17.
35. For a detailed account of Czech-German relations in the nineteenth and twentieth centuries see Benes, Z et al, *Facing History – The evolution of Czech-German Relations in the Czech provinces, 1848–1948,* 2002 (published in English in the Czech Republic).
36. Šmidrkal, V, Konrad, U, Schmoller, H, Perzi, N, (eds.), *Sousedé. Česko-rakouské dějiny,* MUA 2019.
37. Von Kuehnelt-Leddihn, p. 261.